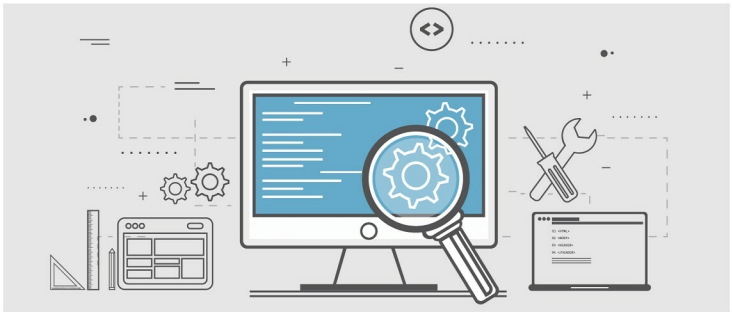


Splinter: An Easy Way to Test Web Applications

Splinter is a Web application testing tool which is built around Python. It automates actions such as visiting specified URLs and interacts with their items. It also removes the drudgery from Web application testing by replacing manual testing with automated testing.



Every one of us makes mistakes—some of these might be trivial and be ignored, while a few that are serious can't be ignored. Hence, it's always a good practice to verify and validate what we do in order to eliminate the possibility of error. So is the case with any software application. The development of a software application is complete only when it's fully verified and validated (its functionality, performance, user interface, etc). Only then is it ready for release. Carrying out all such validations manually is quite time consuming; so, machines perform such repetitive tasks and processes. This is called automation testing. It saves a lot of time while it reduces the risk of any further error caused by human intervention.

There are different automation tools and frameworks available, of which Splinter is one. It lets us automate different manual tasks and processes associated with any Web-based software application. In a Web application, we need to automate the sequence of different actions performed, right from opening the Web browser to checking if it's loading properly for different actions that involve interactions with the application. Splinter is quite good in automating a sequence of actions. It is an open source tool used for testing different Web applications using Python. The tasks needed to be performed by Splinter are written in Python. It lets us automate various browser actions, such as visiting URLs as well as interacting with their different items. It has got easy-

to-use built-in functions for the most frequently performed tasks. A newbie can easily use Splinter and automate any specific process with just a limited knowledge of Python scripting. It acts as an easily usable abstraction layer on top of different available automation tools like Selenium and makes it easy to write automation tests. We can easily automate a plethora of tasks such as opening a browser, clicking on any specific link or accessing any link, just with one or two lines of code using Splinter, while in the case of other open source tools like Selenium, this is a long and complex process.

Splinter even allows us to find different elements of any Web application using its different properties like tag name, text or ID value, xpath, etc. Since Splinter is an open source tool, it's quite easy to get clarifications on anything that's not clear. It is supported by a large community. It even has well maintained documentation which makes it easy for any newbie to master this tool. Apart from all this, Splinter supports various inbuilt libraries making the task of automation easier. We can easily manage different actions performed on more than one Web window at the same time as well as navigate through the history of the page, reload the page, etc.

Features of Splinter

1. Splinter has got one of the simplest APIs among open source tools used for automating different tasks on Web applications. This makes it easy to write automated tests